ANIME CLUB · GRADES 6–8 · LESSON 3

Storytelling Techniques in Anime ✏️

Big Question: What makes you *feel something* — or need to see the next episode right now?

NAME

Your name

DATE

PERIOD

🌀 **Flashback**
Jump to past to reveal what's needed right now

🌱 **Foreshadowing**
Hidden hints planted early — paid off later

⚡ **Cliffhanger**
End at peak tension — Zeigarnik Effect

💛 **Char. Dev.**
Change forced from inside by challenge & choice

📐 **Narrative Arc**
Intro → Rising → Climax → Falling → Resolution

🎬 PART A — CLIP ANALYSIS

Spot the Techniques — Watch, Then Write

CLIP / SCENE	TECHNIQUE(S) USED	EVIDENCE — WHAT SPECIFICALLY SHOWS THIS TECHNIQUE?	HOW DID IT MAKE YOU FEEL?
🌀 *Demon Slayer* Tanjiro's Family (Do Now)	e.g. flashback, character de	What sound / shot / moment gives it away?	I felt... because...
🌱 *Attack on Titan* Foreshadowing clip			
⚡ *Demon Slayer* Mugen Train flashback			
💛 *My Hero Academia* Character development			

QUICK DISCUSSION — FORESHADOWING VS. SPOILER

Can foreshadowing be *too obvious*? What's the difference between a clue and a spoiler?

I think the difference is...

QUICK DISCUSSION — IS A CLIFFHANGER CHEATING?

The **Zeigarnik Effect**: our brains remember unfinished tasks more than completed ones. Is a cliffhanger a valid storytelling tool or cheap manipulation?

I think cliffhangers are... because...

🎨 PART B — STORYBOARD (STUDIO TIME)

Create an Original Anime Scene — 4 Panels

CHARACTER NAME & GENRE:

EMOTION YOU WANT VIEWERS TO FEEL AT THE END:

e.g. heartbroken, inspired, shocked...

WHERE IS THE HIGHEST-TENSION MOMENT?

Panel #___

WHAT MUST THE AUDIENCE UNDERSTAND FROM THIS SCENE?

TECHNIQUES I WILL USE (CHECK ALL THAT APPLY)

- ☐ 🌀 Flashback
- ☐ 🌱 Foreshadowing
- ☐ ⚡ Cliffhanger
- ☐ 💛 Char. Dev.
- ☐ 📐 Narrative Arc

PANEL 1	PANEL 2	PANEL 3	PANEL 4
Draw here stick figures OK!	Draw here	Draw here ← highest tension?	Draw here
TECHNIQUE:	**TECHNIQUE:**	**TECHNIQUE:**	**TECHNIQUE:**
CAPTION: What's happening?	**CAPTION:**	**CAPTION:**	**CAPTION:**

📝 PART C — EXIT TICKET (3 MIN)

Show What You Know

Q1. Name the technique you found most effective today & explain why it works:

Q2. Name the anime + scene and explain how that technique creates emotion:

Q3. Which technique will you use in your own anime story — and how?

🤝 PEER FEEDBACK — GALLERY WALK

Give Great Feedback

1 — Look 👁️
60 sec silent read — notice techniques & emotion

2 — Name 🏷️
"In panel 2, I see a flashback because..."

3 — Question ❓
"What if this panel came first?"

PARTNER'S NAME:

TECHNIQUE I SAW MOST CLEARLY IN THEIR STORYBOARD:

I saw... in panel #... because...

ONE THING I WOULD CHANGE IN MY STORYBOARD AFTER HEARING FEEDBACK:

I would change panel ___ because...

📘 VOCABULARY

Narrative Arc	Flashback	Foreshadowing	Cliffhanger	Char. Dev.
5-stage story shape	Past reveals present	Hidden hints → payoff	Peak tension at end	Change from inside